Wycliffe Associates

Bible Translation Reviewers' Guide

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1:1-11

Background: Luke wrote an account of Jesus' life and sent it to Theophilus. That account is called “the Gospel of Luke” or simply “Luke.” Luke also wrote this book, called “Acts,” to Theophilus.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The author’s (Luke's) first account was about all that Jesus did and taught. [1:1]
- ☐ After Jesus suffered, he showed his apostles that he was alive and taught them about the kingdom of God. [1:3]
- ☐ Jesus told his apostles to wait in Jerusalem for what God the Father had promised. [1:4]
- ☐ Jesus said that they would receive power and be his witnesses, after the Holy Spirit had come upon them. [1:5-8]
- ☐ Jesus was raised up, and a cloud hid him. Then two men in white clothing suddenly appeared. They said that Jesus would return. [1:9-11]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [1:1] From what you see in verse 1, who do you think this book was written to?
   This passage indicates that it was written to Theophilus, because that is the person that Luke (the author) addressed in verse 1.

2. [1:1-2] What did the author tell Theophilus that his first book was about?
   He said that the first book was about all that Jesus did and taught while he was on earth.

3. [1:2] What did Jesus do just before he was taken up?
   He gave his apostles commands through the Holy Spirit.

4. [1:3] How long did Jesus appear to the apostles and show them that he was alive, from what you read in verse 3?
   He appeared to them for 40 days.

5. [1:3] What did Jesus speak of during the 40 days he was with his apostles?
   He spoke about the kingdom of God.

6. [1:4] What did Jesus command the apostles to do?
   He commanded them to remain in Jerusalem and to wait for the promise from the Father.

7. [1:5] What did Jesus tell the apostles about baptism?
   He said that John baptized with water, but they would soon be baptized with the Holy Spirit.

8. [1:6] What question did the apostles ask Jesus about the kingdom?
   The apostles asked if it was time for Jesus to restore the kingdom to Israel.

9. [1:7] What was Jesus’ answer?
   Jesus said it was not for them to know what time the Father had chosen for this to happen.

Acts 1:1-11 continued

10. [1:8] What did Jesus tell the apostles would happen to them when the Holy Spirit came upon them?
    They would receive power.

11. [1:8] Where did Jesus tell the apostles they would be His witnesses?
    Jesus told them they would be his witnesses in Jerusalem and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth.

12. [1:9] What did the apostles see happen to Jesus?
    He was lifted up (into heaven) and hidden in a cloud.

13. [1:10-11] Why do you think the disciples kept looking up into heaven after Jesus was lifted up?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps they were sad that Jesus had gone away. Perhaps they were unsure what to do next.

14. [1:10-11] What did the two men in white tell the apostles?
    They said that Jesus would return in the same way as they had seen him go into heaven.

Comment Section:

2:1-13

Background: The events of this passage happened during the day of Pentecost. The day of Pentecost was part of a Jewish celebration that happened 50 days after each Passover, and many Jews came to Jerusalem for it.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The disciples were all together on the day of Pentecost. [2:1]
- ☐ There was a sound like the rushing wind in the house, and they saw what looked like tongues of fire resting on them. [2:2-3]
- ☐ The disciples were filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other languages. [2:4]
- ☐ Jews from all over the world were in Jerusalem at that time, and they were amazed that each of them could hear people speaking in their languages. [2:5-12]
- ☐ Some people mocked the disciples and said that they had drunk too much wine. [2:13]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [2:1] Where were the disciples on the day of Pentecost?
   They were all in one place together in Jerusalem.

2. [2:2-3] What did the disciples hear and see?
   They heard the sound of a mighty rushing wind, and they saw what looked like tongues of fire resting on each of them.

3. [2:4] What happened to the disciples?
   They were all filled with the Holy Spirit, and they began to speak in other languages.

4. [2:5] Who was in Jerusalem for the day of Pentecost?
   Godly Jews from every nation were in Jerusalem.

5. [2:6] What did the Jews from other nations hear?
   The Jews from other nations heard in their own languages what the disciples were saying.

6. [2:7, 8, 12] What did the Jews from other nations ask?
   They asked how these men from Galilee could speak in languages of different nations. They asked what this could mean.

7. [2:11] What did the Jews from other nations hear the disciples speaking about?
   They heard the disciples speaking about God’s mighty works.

8. [2:12] Why do you think the people were amazed and confused?
   The disciples who did not know their languages were somehow communicating with them in their languages. The people knew that this was not natural.

Acts 2:1-13 continued

9. [2:13] What did the mockers say about the disciples?
They said that the disciples had drunk too much wine.

Comment Section:

3:11-16

Background: In Acts 3:1-10, Peter and John went to the temple and saw a man who was lame and who was asking for money. Peter healed the man in Jesus' name. Immediately the man stood and started walking around.

Three men mentioned in this passage—Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob—were famous ancestors of the Jewish people. Pilate is also mentioned. He was the governor of Judea at the time of Jesus' death and resurrection.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ People ran to Peter, John, and the healed man, and they marveled at what had happened. [3:11]

☐ Peter told the people of Israel that their God had sent Jesus, but they had rejected Jesus and had him killed. [3:11-15]

☐ Peter told them that God had raised Jesus from the dead. [3:15]

☐ Peter told them that the lame man was healed by faith in Jesus' name. [3:16]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [3:11] What happened when Peter, John, and the man who was healed entered Solomon's Portico at the temple?
   They were surrounded by people who were amazed at the healing of the lame man.

2. [3:12] Based on what Peter said in verse 12, what do you think the people believed about the miracle?
   The people apparently thought that Peter and John healed the man by their own power.

3. [3:13] What did Peter say that the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob had done?
   Peter said that God had glorified his servant Jesus.

4. [3:13] What had the people of Israel done to Jesus?
   They had handed him over to be killed, and they had rejected him in front of Pilate.

5. [3:13-14] How was Jesus rejected in front of Pilate?
   Pilate was going to set Jesus free, but the people chose a murderer to be released instead.

6. [3:14-15] What did Peter call Jesus?
   He called Jesus the Holy and Righteous One and the source of life.

7. [3:15] What had God done to Jesus?
   God had raised Jesus from the dead.

8. [3:16] What did Peter say made the lame man strong?
   Faith in Jesus' name made the man strong.

9. [3:16] What did Peter say had given the man perfect health?
   The faith that comes through Jesus gave the man perfect health.

Comment Section:

4:23-31

Background: In Acts 4:1-22, the Jewish religious leaders were outraged that Peter and John were teaching that Jesus had been raised from the dead. So they had a council meeting, and they put Peter and John on trial. The leaders could find no excuse to punish them, so they just commanded them not to teach in Jesus' name and let them go.

In this passage, the believers mention David. About 1,000 years before Jesus came to earth, David was an important king of Israel. David wrote much of the book of Psalms in the Old Testament, and some of his words were prophecies.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ After Peter and John were released, they told the other believers what the chief priests and elders said to them. [4:23]
- ☐ The believers prayed. They quoted a scripture that said that people would oppose the Lord and his Christ. They acknowledged that what happened to Jesus was just what God had planned. [4:24-28]
- ☐ They prayed for the power to speak God's word boldly. [4:29-30]
- ☐ Then the place where they were gathered was shaken, and they were all filled with the Holy Spirit. [4:31]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [4:23] What did Peter and John do after they were released?
   Peter and John went back to the other believers and told them what the chief priests and elders said to them.

2. [4:24] What did the gathering of believers do when Peter and John told them what had happened?
   They prayed, lifting their voices to God.

3. [4:24] What did the believers say the Lord had made?
   They said that he had made the heavens, the earth, the sea, and all that is in them.

4. [4:25] Who did the believers quote in verse 25 as they prayed?
   They quoted the Lord's servant David, who was their ancestor.

5. [4:25] What did David say about the Gentile nations?
   The Gentile nations raged, and they plotted in vain against the Lord God and the Messiah.

6. [4:26] What did David say about the kings of the earth and the rulers?
   They gathered together against the Lord and against his Christ (which means his Anointed One).

7. [4:27] Who did the believers speak about as they prayed in verse 27?
   They spoke about Herod, Pontius Pilate, the Gentiles, and the people of Israel.

8. [4:27] What did the believers say that those people had done?
   Those people had gathered against God's holy servant Jesus, whom God had anointed.

9. [4:28] Who had decided and planned what would happen to Jesus?
   God had decided in advance what would happen.

Acts 4:23-31 continued

10. [4:29-30] What did the believers ask the Lord to do?
    They asked him to enable them to speak his word with boldness, and they asked him to heal people and to give signs and wonders through Jesus' name.

11. [4:31] What happened after the believers were done praying?
    After they prayed, the place where they were gathered was shaken, and they were all filled with the Holy Spirit.

12. [4:31] What did the believers do once they were filled with the Holy Spirit?
    They spoke the word of God boldly.

Comment Section:

5:1-11

Background: Acts 4 says that the believers were united in heart and soul. Those who owned houses or land sold them and brought all the money they received for them to the apostles, so the money could be distributed to those who were in need.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ A man named Ananias and his wife Sapphira sold a piece of property. Then Ananias saved part of the money with Sapphira's full knowledge. He took the rest to the apostles and implied that it was the whole amount. [5:1-2]
- ☐ Peter asked Ananias why he lied to the Holy Spirit, and when he heard that, Ananias fell down dead. [5:3-6]
- ☐ When Sapphira came to Peter, she also lied and fell down dead. [5:7-10]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [5:1] Who were Ananias and Sapphira?
   They were a husband and wife who sold a piece of property.

2. [5:2] What did Ananias and Sapphira do?
   They secretly kept back a part of the sale money. Then Ananias brought the other part of the money to the apostles.

3. [5:2] What do you think that Ananias and Sapphira wanted the apostles and other believers to think?
   (Answer may vary.) The passage indicates that Ananias and Sapphira wanted the apostles and other believers to think that they had brought all of the money from their property sale, as others had done. Perhaps other believers were praised for this kind of generosity. Perhaps Ananias and Sapphira wanted people to think that they were equally generous.

4. [5:3] What question did Peter ask Ananias?
   Peter asked Ananias why he lied to the Holy Spirit and kept part of the price of the land.

5. [5:3] What do you think was the reason that Peter accused Ananias of lying to the Holy Spirit?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps Peter was given divine insight to know that Ananias had lied to the Holy Spirit.

6. [5:4] What do you think was the reason that Peter asked Ananias about the land being his and the money being under his authority?
   (Answer may vary.) It seems like Peter did this to remind Ananias that he did not have to sell the land, and he could have given as much of an offering out of that sale's amount as he wanted. Ananias did not have to lie and pretend to give the whole amount. He did not have to plot with his wife so that they would both tell the same lie.

7. [5:5-6] What happened to Ananias after Peter spoke to him?
   Ananias fell down dead, and young men wrapped him up and took him out to bury him.

Acts 5:1-11 continued

8. [5:7] What happened about 3 hours later?
   Sapphira came to where Peter was, but she did not know what had happened.

9. [5:8] What did Peter ask Sapphira, and how did she answer him?
   Peter asked if they sold the land for a certain amount, and she said yes, that it was the amount.

10. [5:9] What did Peter accuse Ananias and Sapphira of doing?
    He accused them of agreeing to test the Spirit of the Lord.

11. [5:9] What do you think was the reason that Peter said that Ananias and Sapphira tested the Lord?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps, although Ananias and Sapphira must have known that God is holy and punishes sin, they lied to the Lord by pretending to give the full amount of money. Perhaps they thought that they would never get caught.

12. [5:10] What happened to Sapphira?
    She fell down dead, and the young men came and got her body and buried her beside her husband.

13. [5:11] What was the reaction of the church after the death of Ananias and Sapphira?
    The church was filled with great fear when they heard about it.

Comment Section:

6:8-15

Background: There were complaints by the Grecian Jews against the Hebrews, because the Grecian widows were being overlooked in the distribution of help. To correct the problem, the 12 apostles appointed 7 men from among the disciples to oversee the distribution of help. Stephen was one of these 7 men chosen to help the apostles minister to the group of believers.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ Stephen was doing signs and wonders among the people. [6:8]

☐ Some people from a certain synagogue opposed Stephen. [6:9-11]

☐ False witnesses accused Stephen of speaking against God, Moses, and the temple. [6:11-14]

☐ As the Jewish council was about to speak to Stephen, they saw that his face was like that of an angel. [6:15]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [6:8] How was Stephen described?
   He was full of grace and power.

2. [6:8] What was Stephen doing?
   Stephen was doing great signs and wonders among the people.

3. [6:9-10] What did people from the synagogue of the Freedmen do?
   They argued with Stephen.

4. [6:10] Why were these people unable to successfully argue against Stephen?
   They could not successfully argue against Stephen because he spoke with wisdom and by the Spirit.

5. [6:11-12] What did the Freedmen do in verse 11, and what was the result in verse 12?
   The Freedmen paid men to lie and say that Stephen spoke disrespectfully against God and Moses. This stirred up the Jewish elders and scribes, who seized Stephen and brought him to the council.

6. [6:13] What did the false witnesses accuse Stephen of doing?
   They accused him of constantly speaking against the holy place and the law.

7. [6:13] What do you think the holy place was?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps it was either Jerusalem or God's temple in Jerusalem.

8. [6:14] What was their evidence that Stephen had spoken against the holy place and the law?
   They said that they had heard Stephen say that Jesus of Nazareth would destroy that place and would change the customs that Moses had given them.

9. [6:15] What did all those who sat in the council see in verse 15?
   They saw that Stephen's face was like the face of an angel.

Comment Section:

7:44-53

Background: Before this passage, the high priest asked Stephen if his accusers were telling the truth. Stephen then spoke to the council about Israel's history, including when God called Moses to lead the Israelites through the wilderness to the land God had promised to give to them.

In this passage, Stephen spoke about several men who had lived long before that time. He spoke about Joshua, who became Israel's leader after Moses died, and who led the people of Israel into the land that God had promised. Stephen then spoke about King David, who was the most important king of Israel. Finally, he spoke about King Solomon, who was David's son.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Stephen spoke about their ancestors having the tabernacle in the wilderness and in the land that God gave them. [7:44-45]
- ☐ Stephen spoke about David wanting to build a house and about Solomon building a house for God. [7:46-47]
- ☐ Stephen said that God does not live in houses made by people, and he quoted a scripture about it. [7:48-50]
- ☐ Stephen rebuked the people for murdering the Righteous One and for not keeping the law. [7:51-53]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [7:44] What had God told Moses to make?
   God told him to make the tabernacle of the testimony.

2. [7:45] Later, what did the Jews' ancestors do with the tabernacle?
   They took the tabernacle with them when they took possession of the land.

3. [7:45] What did God do to the nations that lived in the land?
   God took the land away from those nations, and he made those nations leave the land.

4. [7:46] What did David ask God to let him do?
   David asked God to let him find a dwelling place for the house of Jacob (or for the God of Jacob).

5. [7:47] What did Solomon do?
   Solomon built the house for God.

6. [7:48] What did Stephen then say about God and houses?
   He said that the Most High does not live in houses made by human hands.

7. [7:49] According to the prophet, what did the Lord say about heaven and earth?
   The Lord said that heaven is his throne, and the earth is his footstool.

8. [7:49-50] What do you think the Lord meant by all that he said in verses 49 and 50?
   (Answer may vary.) His questions seemed to emphasize how much greater than heaven and earth the Lord is. He created it all. The questions also indicated that people cannot build a suitable house for the Lord.

Acts 7:44-53 continued

9. [7:51] What did Stephen call the high priest and the members of the council?
   He called them stiff-necked people. He said that they were uncircumcised in heart and ears.

10. [7:51] What do you think that Stephen meant by this?
    (Answer may vary.) He probably meant that they were stubborn, and that they did not truly love God or listen to God.

11. [7:52] What had their ancestors done to the prophets?
    They persecuted and killed the prophets.

12. [7:52] What did the high priest and the members of the council do to the Righteous One?
    They betrayed and murdered the Righteous One.

13. [7:53] Why do you think Stephen said that the Jews received the law that angels ordained?
    (Answer may vary.) He may have said this to emphasize how holy the law was that they did not keep. Or he may have meant that the Jews claimed to treasure the law as if they received it from angels, yet they ignored it to first kill the prophets and then to kill Jesus (the Righteous One).

Comment Section:

8:14-25

Background: Before this passage, a disciple named Philip went to Samaria and preached about Christ. He also did signs, and many people were healed. Many people believed and were baptized. A sorcerer named Simon also believed and was baptized. Simon followed Philip everywhere. He was amazed by the signs and miracles that Philip did.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The apostles in Jerusalem sent Peter and John to the people in Samaria. [8:14]
- ☐ When Peter and John prayed and laid their hands on the Samaritan believers, those believers received the Holy Spirit. [8:15-17]
- ☐ Simon the sorcerer tried to buy the power of the Holy Spirit from Peter. [8:18-19]
- ☐ Peter told Simon that his heart was not right before God. He said that Simon should repent. [8:20-23]
- ☐ Simon asked Peter and John to pray for him. [8:24]
- ☐ Then Peter and John returned to Jerusalem, and they preached the gospel to many Samaritan villages. [8:25]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [8:14] What did the apostles in Jerusalem do when they heard that those in Samaria had received the word of God?
   They sent Peter and John to Samaria.

2. [8:15] What did Peter and John pray for?
   They prayed that the believers in Samaria would receive the Holy Spirit.

3. [8:16] Up until that time, what had the Samaritan believers experienced?
   They had been baptized into the name of the Lord Jesus.

4. [8:17] What happened when Peter and John put their hands on the believers?
   The believers received the Holy Spirit.

5. [8:18] What did Simon the sorcerer do when he saw the Samaritan believers receive the Holy Spirit?
   He offered Peter and John money.

6. [8:19] What did Simon want?
   He wanted authority to place his hands on people so that they would receive the Holy Spirit.

7. [8:20] Why did Peter want Simon's silver to perish along with Simon?
   Peter wanted this to happen because Simon thought that he could pay money to get God's gift.

8. [8:21] Why did Simon have no part in this matter?
   Simon had no part because his heart was not right with God.

9. [8:22] What did Peter say might happen if Simon repented and prayed to the Lord?
   The Lord might forgive Simon for what was in his heart.

Acts 8:14-25 continued

10. [8:23] What condition did Peter say that Simon was in?
    Peter said that Simon was poisoned by bitterness and in bondage to his sin.

11. [8:24] How did Simon respond to Peter's rebuke?
    Simon asked Peter to pray for him so that nothing bad would happen to him.

12. [8:25] Where did Peter and John go, and what did they do on the way?
    As they went back to Jerusalem, they preached the gospel to many Samaritan villages.

Comment Section:

9:1-9

Background: Acts 8:1 and 3 mention a man named Saul. Saul approved of Stephen's execution, and he tried to destroy the church. He looked for Christians and took them to prison.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ Saul was going to Damascus to arrest believers and take them to Jerusalem. [9:1-2]

☐ A light from heaven shone all around Saul, and a voice said, "Saul why are you persecuting me?" [9:3-4]

☐ The voice said, "I am Jesus whom you are persecuting. Go into the city and wait to be told what to do." [9:5-6]

☐ Saul could not see, so his companions led him into Damascus. [9:7-9]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [9:1] Who did Saul threaten to murder?
   Saul threatened to murder the disciples of the Lord.

2. [9:1-2] Why did Saul ask the high priest for letters for the synagogues in Damascus?
   He wanted to look for people who belonged to the Way, tie them up, and take them to Jerusalem.

3. [9:2] What do you think it means to belong to the Way?
   It probably means to be a follower of Jesus. (Jesus had said that he is the Way.)

4. [9:3] What happened to Saul as he traveled to Damascus?
   A light from heaven shone all around Saul.

5. [9:4] Saul heard a voice. What did it say to him?
   The voice said, "Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me?"

6. [9:5] Who was speaking to Saul?
   Jesus was speaking to Saul.

7. [9:5] What do you think was the reason that Jesus said that Saul was persecuting him?
   Saul was persecuting Jesus' followers, and Jesus considered that to be the same as persecuting him.

8. [9:6] What did Jesus tell Saul to do, and what did Jesus say would happen?
   He told Saul to go into the city, and someone would tell Saul what he must do.

9. [9:7] What did the men traveling with Saul hear and see?
   They heard the voice, but they did not see Jesus speaking to Saul.

10. [9:8] What happened when Saul got up and opened his eyes?
    He could not see anything.

Acts 9:1-9 continued

11. [9:8] How did Saul go into the city?
    The men who were traveling with him led him by the hand into Damascus.

12. [9:9] What did Saul do for 3 days?
    He was unable to see and did not eat or drink for 3 days.

Comment Section:

10:27-35

Background: The beginning of Acts 10 is about Cornelius. Cornelius was a Gentile who feared God and prayed constantly. One day an angel came to him in a vision. The angel told him to send men to the city of Joppa to get Simon Peter. So, Cornelius sent three men to get Peter.

The next day, as Peter was praying, he had a vision in which he was told to eat animals that the scriptures called unclean. Three times in the vision God said that what He has created as clean should not be called unclean. Then the three men came to Peter. The Spirit told Peter to go with them. The next morning, Peter went with the men to Cornelius's house in Caesarea. Cornelius fell down to worship Peter, but Peter told him to stand up.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ When Peter arrived, he told Cornelius that God had shown him not to call any person unclean. [10:28-29]
- ☐ Peter asked Cornelius why he had called for him, and Cornelius told him about the angel that had appeared to him. [10:30-33]
- ☐ Peter said that he now understood that God does not show partiality. Instead, God accepts people in all nations that fear him and do what is right. [10:35]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [10:27] What did Peter see when he came into the house?
   He saw many people gathered together.

2. [10:28] What did Peter say was not lawful for a Jewish man to do?
   He said that it was not lawful for a Jewish man to associate with a foreigner or to visit a foreigner.

3. [10:28-29] Why did Peter come to Cornelius without arguing?
   He came because God had shown him that he should not call any man defiled or unclean.

4. [10:28] What do you think was the reason that Peter normally would have considered Cornelius to be unclean?
   Peter would probably have considered Cornelius to be unclean because Cornelius was a foreigner, a Gentile.

5. [10:30] What had happened while Cornelius was praying four days before this time?
   A man in bright clothing stood before him.

6. [10:30] What do you think was the reason that Cornelius told Peter about the bright clothing?
   (Answer may vary.) He probably did this because this is what he saw. It probably let Peter know that the man that Cornelius saw was really an angel.

7. [10:31] What had the man told Cornelius about his prayer and about what he had given to the poor?
   He said that God had heard Cornelius's prayer and that Cornelius's giving had reminded God about him.

8. [10:32] What did the man tell Cornelius about Simon Peter?
   He told Cornelius where Simon Peter was staying.

Acts 10:27-35 continued

9. [10:33] What did Cornelius and those with him want to hear?
   They wanted to hear everything that the Lord had instructed Peter to say.

10. [10:34] What did Peter now understand about God?
    Peter understood that God treats all people the same.

11. [10:35] Who does God accept?
    God accepts anyone in any nation who fears God and who does what is right.

Comment Section:

12:1-12

Background: This passage explains that King Herod arrested and killed people. This probably meant that the king told his soldiers to do these things, and his soldiers obeyed him. This passage also mentions that four squads of soldiers guarded Peter. This probably meant that four groups of soldiers took turns guarding Peter all day and all night so that he would not be able to escape.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ King Herod arrested members of the church, and he had James the brother of John put to death. [12:1-2]
- ☐ Herod had Peter arrested and put in prison. [12:3-4]
- ☐ The church prayed for Peter. [12:5]
- ☐ One night, an angel came to Peter's prison cell and released Peter from his chains. [12:6-8]
- ☐ Peter followed the angel out of the prison, but he thought that he was seeing a vision. [12:9-10]
- ☐ After the angel left him, Peter realized that he had been rescued. [12:11]
- ☐ He went to the place where people had gathered to pray. [12:12]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [12:1] What did King Herod do?
   King Herod arrested some who belonged to the church.

2. [12:2] Who did Herod kill with the sword?
   Herod killed James, the brother of John.

3. [12:3] What else did Herod do, and why did he do it?
   Herod arrested Peter. Herod did this because he saw that the Jews were pleased when he killed James.

4. [12:4] Who guarded Peter in prison?
   Four squads of soldiers guarded Peter.

5. [12:4] What did Herod plan to do to Peter?
   He planned to put him on trial in front of the people after the Passover.

6. [12:5] What was the church doing while Peter was in prison?
   The church was earnestly praying to God for Peter.

7. [12:6] What was Peter doing on the night before Herod was going to bring him out for trial?
   Peter was sleeping.

8. [12:6] How was Peter guarded?
   He was chained. He was between two soldiers. There were also guards at the prison door.

9. [12:7] Who appeared in Peter's cell, and what did he do?
   An angel appeared and woke Peter up.

Acts 12:1-11 continued

10. [12:7] What happened to the chains?
    They fell off Peter's hands.

11. [12:7-8] What did the angel tell Peter to do?
    He told Peter to get up, to put on his clothes and sandals, and to follow him.

12. [12:9] What did Peter think about what was happening?
    He did not know that what was happening was real. He thought that he was seeing a vision.

13. [12:10] After they passed by the guards and came to the iron gate, what happened?
    The gate opened by itself.

14. [12:10-11] What happened after Peter was out of prison and the angel of the Lord left him?
    Peter realized that he was not dreaming. He also realized that the Lord had rescued him from Herod and from what the Jewish people were expecting.

15. [12:1-11] What do you think the Jewish people were expecting?
    (Answer may vary.) They were probably expecting that there would be a trial. They were pleased that Herod had killed James, so they probably hoped that Herod would condemn Peter to death also.

16. [12:12] Where did Peter go in verse 12?
    He went to the house of Mary, the mother of John. Many people had gathered there to pray.

Comment Section:

13:42-48

Background: In the earlier chapters of Acts, a man named Saul became a Christian. He was filled with the Holy Spirit and began to teach others about Christ. Saul was also called Paul. The Lord sent Paul with a man called Barnabas to teach the gospel in various places. One Sabbath day, they taught in a synagogue. A synagogue was a place where Jews met to worship God.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The people at the synagogue begged Paul and Barnabas to speak again on the next Sabbath. [13:42]
- ☐ Many people followed Paul and Barnabas, who continued to speak with them. [13:43]
- ☐ On the next Sabbath, many more people came to listen to Paul and Barnabas. [13:44]
- ☐ The Jews became jealous and opposed Paul's teaching. [13:45]
- ☐ Paul and Barnabas said that they had to teach the Jews first, but now they would go to the Gentiles. [13:46-47]
- ☐ Their words made the Gentiles rejoice. [13:48]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [13:42] As Paul and Barnabas left the synagogue, what did the people beg them to do?
   They begged Paul and Barnabas to teach them again on the next Sabbath.

2. [13:43] When the meeting ended, who followed Paul and Barnabas?
   Many Jews and devout Gentiles who converted to Judaism followed them.

3. [13:44-45] What happened when Paul and Barnabas returned to the synagogue a week later?
   Almost the whole city gathered to hear the word of the Lord. But the Jews were jealous and spoke against all that Paul preached.

4. [13:46] What did Paul and Barnabas tell the Jews after they rejected Paul's message?
   Paul and Barnabas said that they had to speak the word of God to the Jews first. Because the Jews rejected it, Paul and Barnabas would now turn to the Gentiles.

5. [13:47] Why did God appoint Paul and Barnabas to be a light for the Gentiles?
   God did this so that they would bring the message of salvation to the most distant parts of the earth.

6. [13:48] How did the Gentiles respond?
   They rejoiced and glorified the word of the Lord. All those God appointed to have eternal life believed.

Comment Section:

14:8-20

Background: In the passage before this one, Paul and Barnabas preached the gospel in Iconium, but some people there tried to kill them. So Paul and Barnabas fled to another city called Lystra. They continued to preach the gospel there. Many people in Lystra worshiped false gods such as Zeus and Hermes.

In this passage, some people in Lystra tried to stone Paul. Stoning meant to throw heavy stones to hit a person, so that the person would die from the impact of the stones.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Paul healed a lame man in Lystra. [14:8-10]
- ☐ The people of Lystra thought that Paul and Barnabas were gods. They tried to worship Paul and Barnabas. [14:11-13]
- ☐ Paul and Barnabas were upset that people wanted to worship them. [14:14]
- ☐ Paul and Barnabas talked to the people about the one true God. [14:15-17]
- ☐ It was still difficult for them to stop the crowd from worshiping them. [14:18]
- ☐ Jews from Antioch and Iconium came to Lystra and persuaded the people to stone Paul. Then they dragged him outside the city because they thought he was dead. [14:19]
- ☐ Paul got up and went back into the city. Then he and Barnabas traveled to Derbe. [14:20]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [14:8] How long had the man at Lystra been unable to walk?
   He was disabled from the time he was born, and he had never walked.

2. [14:9] What did Paul notice about this man?
   Paul saw that he had faith to be made well.

3. [14:10] What did Paul tell the man to do, and what happened?
   Paul told the man to stand up, and the man jumped up and walked.

4. [14:11-12] After this miracle, who did the crowd think that Barnabas and Paul were?
   They thought that Barnabas was the false god named Zeus, and that Paul was the false god named Hermes.

5. [14:13] Why did the priest of Zeus bring oxen and wreaths to the gates?
   He did this so that he and the people could offer a sacrifice to Paul and Barnabas.

6. [14:14-15] What did Paul and Barnabas do when they understood that the men of Lystra wanted to worship them as gods?
   Paul and Barnabas tore their clothes, rushed into the crowd, and said that they were human beings just like the people of Lystra.

7. [14:14] What do you think was the reason that Paul and Barnabas tore their clothes?
   (Answer may vary.) They seemed to do this to show how upset they were about the terrible thing the people were doing by worshiping them.

Acts 14:8-20 continued

8. [14:15] What do you think were the useless things that Paul and Barnabas were talking about in verse 15?
   (Answer may vary.) They were probably referring to worshiping false gods and sacrificing to them.

9. [14:15] What did Paul and Barnabas say about the true God in verse 15?
   He is the living God. He made the heavens, the earth, the sea, and everything in them.

10. [14:16] In the past ages, what had God allowed the people of the nations to do?
    He allowed them to live according to their own ways.

11. [14:17] How had God made himself known to people?
    He did good to people, and he gave them rain and fruitful seasons. He filled them with food and gladness.

12. [14:18] How do you think that the people responded to Paul and Barnabas's words?
    (Answer may vary.) They did not seem to listen well to these words. The people apparently still wanted to sacrifice to Paul and Barnabas. Paul and Barnabas had difficulty in making them stop.

13. [14:19] Verse 19 says that the Jews from Antioch and Iconium persuaded the crowd. What do you think that these Jews persuaded the crowd to think about Paul?
    (Answer may vary.) They seemed to persuade the crowd to think that Paul was not teaching the truth. They seemed to persuade the crowd to think that Paul was not a god, and that he was worthy of death.

14. [14:19] What did they do to Paul?
    They threw stones at him to kill him, and they dragged him out of the city when they thought he was dead.

15. [14:20] What did Paul do while the disciples were standing around him?
    He got up. Then he went back into the city.

16. [14:20] What did Paul and Barnabas do the next day?
    They went to Derbe.

Comment Section:

15:1-21

Background: The beginning of this passage is about Antioch, which was a Gentile city with many Jewish people. When Gentile men wanted to convert and become Jews, they had to be circumcised to be like the Jewish men were. However, when Gentiles became Christians, they did not need to be circumcised, since Jesus had not mentioned circumcision as necessary for those who believe him for salvation. The church in Antioch was made up of both Jews and Gentiles.

In the later parts of this passage, James called Peter “Simon," which was Peter’s Jewish name.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Some men who came from Judea were teaching that men had to be circumcised in order to be saved. [15:1]
- ☐ Paul and Barnabas and some others went to Jerusalem to meet with the apostles and elders about this issue. [15:2]
- ☐ When they got to Jerusalem, some believers there said that the Gentile believers did need to be circumcised and to follow the law of Moses. [15:3-6]
- ☐ Peter said that God already gave the Holy Spirit to the Gentile believers and cleansed their hearts by faith. [15:7-9]
- ☐ He asked why the brothers were testing God by putting other requirements onto the Gentiles, when they believed that God saved all people through grace. [15:10-11]
- ☐ Paul and Barnabas reported the signs and wonders that God did through them among the Gentiles. [15:12]
- ☐ James quoted Old Testament passages about Gentiles who would seek God and who would be called by God’s name. [15:13-18]
- ☐ Then James said that they should not trouble the Gentiles who turned to God, but there were some things that they should tell those Gentiles to stay away from. [15:19-21]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [15:1-2] What did some men from Judea teach the believers in Antioch?
   They taught that the believers had to be circumcised according to the custom of Moses in order to be saved.

2. [15:2] How did Paul and Barnabas react?
   They strongly disagreed and debated with those teaching it. (This indicates that Paul and Barnabas did not think that the believers in Antioch needed to be circumcised.)

3. [15:2-3] What did the church in Antioch do about this issue?
   They appointed Paul and Barnabas and some other believers to go to Jerusalem to talk with the apostles and elders.

4. [15:3] What did Paul and Barnabas do as they went through Phoenicia and Samaria, and how did the believers feel about it?
   Paul and Barnabas described to them how Gentiles had converted to Christ, and the believers were very happy about it.

5. [15:4] How did the church, apostles, and elders respond when Paul and Barnabas arrived in Jerusalem?
   They welcomed Paul and Barnabas.

Acts 15:1-21 continued

6. [15:4-5] How did some Pharisees, who had become believers in Jesus, respond when Paul and Barnabas reported all that God had done with them?
   These believers (who had been Pharisees) said that it was necessary to circumcise the Gentiles and to command them to keep the law of Moses.

7. [15:7] According to Peter, who chose for the Gentiles to hear and believe the gospel?
   God chose for that to happen.

8. [15:8] How did God show that the Gentile believers were acceptable to him?
   He gave them the Holy Spirit, just as he gave the Holy Spirit to the Jewish believers.

9. [15:9] How did God cleanse the hearts of both the Gentiles and Jews?
   He cleansed their hearts by faith.

10. [15:10] How did Peter say that some of the Jewish believers were testing God?
    They wanted to put a yoke on the Gentile believers that even the Jews could not carry.

11. [15:10] What do you think Peter meant by putting a yoke on the Gentile believers that the Jews could not carry?
    He was apparently talking about requiring the Gentiles to be circumcised and to keep the law of Moses.

12. [15:11] How were the Jewish believers and the Gentile believers saved?
    They were saved through the grace of the Lord Jesus.

13. [15:12] What did Barnabas and Paul tell the group after Peter spoke?
    Barnabas and Paul told them about the signs and wonders that God did among the Gentiles.

14. [15:14] For what purpose did God graciously help the Gentiles?
    God did it to take some of them to be people for himself.

15. [15:15-16] According to the prophets, what did God say that he would build again?
    He would rebuild the tabernacle of David.

16. [15:17] Why would God rebuild the tabernacle of David?
    He would do it so that the rest of humanity would seek the Lord.

17. [15:17] Who was included with that rest of humanity?
    The Gentiles who were called by God's name were included. This means the Gentiles who belonged to God.

18. [15:15-18] What do you think was the reason that James quoted what the prophets said?
    Verse 15 indicates that James quoted the prophets to indicate that what they said had come true. First, God had become present with Israel again, through David's descendant Jesus. Next, other people began to seek God, and Gentiles were being called by God's name. This fits with what Simon Peter said about Gentiles being saved.

19. [15:19] What did James decide?
    James decided that they should not make it difficult for the Gentiles who turned to God.

Acts 15:1-21 continued

20. [15:20] What did James say that the Gentiles should stay away from?
    They should stay away from things polluted by idols, from sexual immorality, from the meat of strangled animals, and from blood.

21. [15:20] What do you think it meant to stay away from these things?
    This apparently meant that the Gentiles
    - should not eat food offered to idols,
    - should not be sexually immoral,
    - should not eat the meat of strangled animals, and
    - should not eat or drink blood.

22. [15:21] What was the reason James gave for telling the Gentiles to stay away from those things?
    The reason was because Jews had taught these commands from the law of Moses every Sabbath in every city.

Comment Section:

16:11-15

Background: Paul had a vision of a man in Macedonia who asked him to come to Macedonia and help them, so Paul and his companions planned to go there. Luke, the author of this book, was one of Paul's companions on this journey, so in this part of his book, Luke wrote about being there along with the group.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ Paul and his companions went to Philippi in Macedonia. [16:11-12]

☐ They went to the river and spoke with the women there. [16:13]

☐ Lydia listened, and she and her household were baptized. [16:14-15]

☐ After she was baptized, Lydia begged them to let her host them in her home. [16:15]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [16:11-12] Where did Paul and his companions sail, after they left Troas?
   They sailed to Samothrace and Neapolis, and then to Philippi.

2. [16:12] What does the passage say about the city of Philippi?
   Philippi was a Roman colony, and it was the most important city in the district of Macedonia.

3. [16:13] What did Paul and his companions do on the Sabbath day?
   They went to the river. Then they sat down and spoke with the women who had gathered there.

4. [16:13] What do you think that the women had gathered to do?
   (Answer may vary.) The text indicates that they might have gathered by the river to pray.

5. [16:14] Who was one of the women that Paul and his companions met at the river?
   They met Lydia, who was a merchant and a worshiper of God.

6. [16:14] What did the Lord do for Lydia?
   The Lord opened Lydia's heart to listen to what Paul said.

7. [16:14-15] What happened to Lydia and the members of her household after Lydia listened to Paul?
   They were baptized.

8. [16:14-15] What do you think happened between verses 14 and 15?
   The passage indicates that Lydia and her household responded to the gospel, because Paul and his companions baptized them.

9. [16:15] What did Lydia persuade Paul and his companions to do?
   She persuaded them to stay at her house.

Comment Section:

18:24-28

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ A Jew named Apollos came to Ephesus. [18:24]
- ☐ Apollos accurately taught about Jesus, but he only knew the baptism of John. [18:25]
- ☐ When Priscilla and Aquila heard Apollos speaking in the synagogue, they explained the way of God to him more accurately. [18:26]
- ☐ Apollos received letters from the brothers and went to Achaia. [18:27]
- ☐ Apollos refuted the Jews in public debate. He showed by the scriptures that Jesus was the Christ. [18:28]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [18:24] Who was Apollos?
   Apollos was a Jew from Alexandria. He spoke well, and he had a powerful knowledge of scripture.

2. [18:24-25] What did Apollos do when he came to Ephesus?
   Apollos accurately taught about Jesus, but he only knew about the baptism of John.

3. [18:26] Where did Apollos speak in Ephesus?
   Apollos spoke in the synagogue.

4. [18:26] What did Priscilla and Aquila do after they heard Apollos speak?
   They took Apollos aside and explained the way of God to him more accurately.

5. [18:27] Where did Apollos want to go from Ephesus?
   Apollos wanted to go from Ephesus to Achaia.

6. [18:27] How did the brothers in Ephesus help Apollos?
   The brothers in Ephesus encouraged him. They also wrote letters to the disciples in Achaia so that Apollos would be welcomed there.

7. [18:27-28] What did Apollos do when he arrived in Achaia?
   Apollos helped those who believed, because he powerfully argued against the Jews, and he proved from the scriptures that Jesus is the Christ.

Comment Section:

19:1-7

Background: Corinth was a city in Achaia.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Paul went to Ephesus and met some disciples. [19:1]
- ☐ Those disciples had not received the Holy Spirit. [19:2]
- ☐ They had been baptized into John's baptism. [19:3]
- ☐ Paul taught them about Jesus, and they were baptized in Jesus' name. [19:4-5]
- ☐ Paul put his hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit. [19:6]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [19:1] What happened while Apollos was in Corinth?
   Paul went to Ephesus and met some disciples.

2. [19:2] What did Paul say to the disciples?
   Paul asked them if they had received the Holy Spirit when they believed.

3. [19:3] What did the disciples reply to Paul?
   They told Paul that they had not even heard of the Holy Spirit.

4. [19:3] What baptism had they been baptized into?
   They had been baptized into John's baptism.

5. [19:4] What was John's baptism?
   It was a baptism of repentance.

6. [19:4] According to Paul, what had John told the people they should do?
   They should believe in Jesus, the one who would come after John.

7. [19:4-5] What happened after Paul explained what John taught?
   They were baptized in the name of Jesus.

8. [19:6] What happened after Paul put his hands on the people?
   The Holy Spirit came on them, and they spoke in tongues and prophesied.

9. [19:7] How many disciples did this happen to?
   There were twelve men in all.

Comment Section:

20:7-12

Background: In the passage before this one, Paul and his companions sailed to the city of Troas.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ While he was at Troas, Paul spoke to the believers late into the night. [20:7]

☐ A young man fell asleep while listening. He fell out of a window and died. [20:9]

☐ Paul took the young man in his arms and the young man lived again. [20:10-12]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [20:7] What did Paul do when the believers were gathered to break bread in Troas?
   Paul spoke to the believers, and his talk went until midnight.

2. [20:7] Why did Paul speak so long?
   He spoke so long because he planned to leave them the next day.

3. [20:9] Who was Eutychus and what happened to him?
   Eutychus was a young man who was listening to Paul. He was sitting in a window and fell asleep, and then he fell out of the window and died.

4. [20:9] What story of the building did Eutychus fall from?
   He fell from the third story.

5. [20:10] What did Paul say after he had stretched himself out on Eutychus and embraced him?
   Paul told the people not to be upset, because Eutychus had become alive.

6. [20:11] After going upstairs and eating, how much longer did Paul talk with the believers?
   He talked with them until dawn.

7. [20:12] What do you think it means that they brought the boy back alive?
   (Answer may vary.) The passage indicates that God miraculously raised the young man to life through Paul's actions. Then, after Paul left at dawn, the people probably took Eutychus back to his home.

Comment Section:

21:27-36

Background: After preaching in various cities, Paul and his companions went to Jerusalem. There he told the elders in the church what God had done among the Gentiles. The elders said that some of the Jewish believers had heard that Paul taught Jews not to keep the law. This was not true. So, the elders asked Paul to go to the temple with some other men so that they could all purify themselves and let the priests know when they would return to present their offerings. This would show the Jewish Christians that Paul was obeying the law. Paul did this.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jews from Asia told a crowd of people that Paul taught against the law and that he had defiled the temple. [21:27-28]
- ☐ The Jews had seen Paul with Trophimus the Ephesian in the city. They thought that Paul had taken Trophimus into the temple. [21:29]
- ☐ The people grabbed Paul and dragged him out of the temple gates. [21:30]
- ☐ They were trying to kill him, and news reached the Roman chief captain that Jerusalem was in an uproar. [21:31]
- ☐ The Roman chief captain immediately took soldiers there and told them to bind Paul in chains. [21:32-33]
- ☐ The chief captain could not find out the truth from the crowd's shouts about Paul and what he had done. [21:33-34]
- ☐ The soldiers had to carry Paul into the fortress to protect him from the violent, shouting crowd. [21:35-36]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [21:27] Where did some Jews from Asia see Paul?
   They saw him in the temple.

2. [21:27-28] How did Jews from Asia stir up the crowd?
   The Jews from Asia cried out that Paul taught against the people, the law, and the temple. They said that he had defiled the temple by bringing Greeks into it.

3. [21:29] Why did the Jews think Paul had brought Greeks into the temple?
   They had seen Trophimus, who was from Ephesus, with Paul in the city. They assumed Paul had brought him into the temple.

4. [21:30-31] What did the crowd do to Paul?
   They dragged Paul outside the temple and tried to kill him.

5. [21:31] What news did the chief captain of the company of soldiers hear?
   He heard that all Jerusalem was in an uproar.

6. [21:32] What did the crowd do when they saw the chief captain and the soldiers?
   They stopped beating Paul.

7. [21:33] What did the chief captain of the soldiers do to Paul?
   He took hold of Paul and commanded his soldiers to bind Paul with two chains.

Acts 21:27-36 continued

8. [21:33-34] Why was the chief captain unable to learn the truth about the uproar?
   Some people in the crowd were shouting one thing, and some people were shouting something else. There was a lot of noise.

9. [21:34] What did the chief captain tell his soldiers to do?
   He told them to take Paul into the fortress.

10. [21:34] What do you think was the reason for taking Paul into the fortress?
    (Answer may vary.) The captain probably wanted to stop the uproar and find out what Paul had done to cause it. Perhaps he thought Paul would be killed.

11. [21:35] Why did the soldiers carry Paul?
    They carried him because the crowd was so violent.

12. [21:36] What was the crowd doing?
    The crowd was shouting that he should be taken away.

13. [21:36] What do you think the crowd wanted the chief captain to do?
    (Answer may vary.) Probably they wanted him to take Paul away from there. They also may have wanted him to kill Paul.

Comment Section:

22:22-29

Background: In an earlier passage, Paul got permission from the chief captain to stand on the steps of the fortress and talk to the people. Then Paul told them that in the past he had persecuted the church, but then he had met the risen Lord Jesus. The Lord had told Paul to leave Jerusalem because the Jews would not accept Paul's testimony about him. Then the Lord had sent Paul far away to the Gentiles.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The people were angry about what Paul said, and they wanted to kill him. [22:22]
- ☐ The captain ordered that Paul should be questioned and whipped. [22:23-24]
- ☐ When they were about to whip Paul, Paul asked if the law allowed them to whip a Roman citizen who had not been put on trial. [22:25]
- ☐ The chief captain was afraid when he learned that Paul had been born a Roman citizen. [22:26-29]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [22:22-23] How did the crowd react after they heard the last thing that Paul said?
   They shouted that Paul should not be allowed to live, they took off their cloaks, and they threw dust into the air.

2. [22:24] What did the chief captain order to be done to Paul?
   He ordered that Paul should be taken into the fortress and questioned with scourging.

3. [22:25] What did the soldiers do to Paul?
   They tied him down with leather straps.

4. [22:25] What did Paul ask the centurion who was going to scourge him?
   Paul asked the centurion if it was legal to scourge a Roman citizen who had not been put on trial.

5. [22:26] What did the centurion do?
   He told the chief captain that Paul was a Roman citizen and asked him what to do.

6. [22:28] How had the chief captain and Paul each become Roman citizens?
   The chief captain became a Roman citizen through a large payment of money. Paul was born a Roman citizen.

7. [22:29] Why was the chief captain afraid?
   The chief captain was afraid because he had tied Paul up, even though he was a Roman citizen.

Comment Section:

23:23-30

Background: The chief captain took Paul to the chief priests to find out what they were accusing him of. When Paul spoke, there was an uproar, so the captain took Paul back to the fortress. Then he learned that some Jews were planning to trap Paul and kill him.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ The chief captain ordered that Paul should be taken to Felix, the governor at Caesarea. [23:23-24]

☐ The chief captain wrote a letter to Felix that told why he was sending Paul to him. [23:25-30]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [23:23-24] What did the chief captain tell two centurions to do?
   He told them to take Paul along with 200 soldiers, 70 horsemen, and 200 spearmen to the governor Felix in Caesarea that night.

2. [23:25] What was the name of the chief captain?
   His name was Claudius Lysias.

3. [23:27] What did the chief captain write that he did for Paul?
   He wrote that he rescued Paul from the Jews who were about to kill him.

4. [23:27] What did he write was his reason for rescuing Paul?
   He wrote that he rescued Paul because he learned that Paul was a Roman citizen.

5. [23:28] What did the captain write that he did next, and why did he do this?
   He took Paul to the Jews' council because he wanted to know what they were accusing him of.

6. [23:29] What did the captain write about how serious the Jews' accusations were?
   He wrote that the accusations did not deserve death or imprisonment.

7. [23:30] What did the captain write that he did when he heard about the plot against Paul?
   He sent Paul to the governor and told his accusers to bring their charges against Paul to the governor.

8. [23:30] What do you think the captain wanted the governor to do?
   (Answer may vary.) It seems that he wanted the governor to judge Paul's case.

Comment Section:

24:10-16

Background: The high priest, some elders, and an orator went to the governor Felix and told him about their charges against Paul. They said that Paul caused Jews throughout the world to rebel. They called him a leader of the Nazarene sect. Then they said that Paul tried to dishonor their temple.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ Paul said that he did not do the things that the Jews said that he did. [24:11-13]

☐ Paul told the governor what he believed and how he lived. [24:14-16]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [24:10] What did Paul say was the reason that he was glad to explain himself to the governor?
   He said it was because the governor had been a judge to the nation for many years.

2. [24:10] What do you think was Paul's reason for saying that?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps he was showing respect to the governor. This might be indicated because he expressed confidence in the governor's ability to judge well.

3. [24:11] How long ago had Paul gone to worship in Jerusalem?
   It had not been more than 12 days ago.

4. [24:12] What did Paul say about his behavior in the synagogues and in the city?
   He did not argue with anyone or stir up a crowd there.

5. [24:13]. What did Paul say about the accusations the Jews had made against him?
   He said that no one could prove those accusations.

6. [24:14] Who did Paul say he served?
   He said that he served their ancestors' God.

7. [24:14] What did Paul say about the law and what was written in the prophets?
   He said that he believed it all.

8. [24:15] What did Paul say was the same about himself and the Jews who were accusing him?
   They all had the hope that God would resurrect both the righteous people and the wicked people.

9. [24:16] What did Paul say he worked hard to have?
   He worked hard to have a blameless conscience before God and people.

Comment Section:

25:1-12

Background: Before this passage, Paul told about what he was doing in Jerusalem, about the Jews from Asia, and about what he had said to the Jewish council. Then Governor Felix put Paul in custody and said that he would decide the case later. But after two years, Paul was still in custody when Festus became governor in Felix's place.

In this passage, Paul spoke about Caesar. Caesar was the Roman emperor, and Felix was his governor over the province of Judea.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Governor Festus went to Jerusalem. [25:1]
- ☐ The chief priests asked the governor to summon Paul to Jerusalem so they could ambush him on the way. [25:2-3]
- ☐ Festus told them to go to Caesarea and bring their charges there. [25:4-5]
- ☐ The Jews came to Caesarea and brought charges against Paul which they could not prove. [25:6-7]
- ☐ Paul told Festus that he was not guilty of any of the charges the Jews brought against him. [25:8]
- ☐ Festus wanted to do a favor for the Jews, so he asked if Paul would go to Jerusalem to stand trial. [25:9]
- ☐ Paul said that he ought to be tried there, and that he had done no wrong to the Jews. [25:10]
- ☐ Paul said that if there was nothing to the Jews' charges, no one could give him up to them. Then Paul appealed to Caesar. [25:11]
- ☐ Festus agreed and said that Paul would go before Caesar. [25:12]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [25:1-2] What happened when Festus went from Caesarea to Jerusalem?
   The chief priest and other Jewish leaders asked Festus to send Paul to Jerusalem for a trial.

2. [25:3] Why did the Jews want Paul to come to Jerusalem?
   The Jewish leaders intended to kill Paul while he was on his way to Jerusalem.

3. [25:4-5] What did Festus tell the Jewish leaders?
   Festus said that they should go with him to Caesarea and accuse Paul there.

4. [25:6-7] What did the Jewish leaders do when Paul was brought to Festus?
   They brought many serious charges against Paul that they could not prove.

5. [25:8] How did Paul defend himself from these charges?
   Paul said that he had not sinned against the law of the Jews, against the temple, or against Caesar.

6. [25:9] Why did Festus ask Paul if he wanted to go to Jerusalem and be judged by Festus there?
   Festus wanted to gain favor with the Jews.

Acts 25:1-12 continued

7. [25:9] How do you think Festus would gain favor with the Jews by asking that?
   (Answer may vary.) It was probably what the Jews had asked Festus to do, so he wanted to grant their request.

8. [25:10] What do you think Paul meant when he said that he was standing before the judgment seat of Caesar?
   (Answer may vary.) This probably meant that Paul was speaking to the governor who was judging his case, and that the governor represented Caesar.

9. [25:10] What do you think was Paul's reason for appealing to Caesar?
   (Answer may vary.) Paul probably did not want Festus to hand him over to the Jews. Perhaps Paul also realized that Festus would not judge him justly, because Festus was saying things to try to please the Jews.

10. [25:12] What did Festus say after he talked with his council?
    Festus said that Paul had appealed to Caesar, so Paul would go to Caesar.

Comment Section:

27:13-26

Background: In an earlier passage, King Agrippa came to Caesarea to visit Governor Festus. Festus asked the king to listen to Paul. After Paul spoke to him, King Agrippa said that Paul could have been freed if he had not appealed to Caesar. Then Paul and some other prisoners were sent on a ship to sail to Italy, where Caesar was located. The trip took a long time, and it became the time of year that was dangerous for sailing. At a place called Fair Havens, Paul warned the men about the danger, but the ship centurion did not listen and tried to keep sailing around the island of Crete.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The sailors began to sail because a gentle wind blew. [27:13]
- ☐ But then a strong wind drove the ship out of their control. [27:14-15]
- ☐ The sailors tried to make the ship safe by throwing the ship's equipment into the water. [27:16-19]
- ☐ After many days they gave up hope that they would be saved. [27:20]
- ☐ Paul told them that they should have listened to him and not set sail. [27:21]
- ☐ He told them to take courage, because none would die. Only the ship would be lost. [27:22]
- ☐ Paul said that he had seen an angel sent from God whom he served. [27:23]
- ☐ The angel assured Paul that he would survive to stand trial before Caesar, and all on the ship with him would be saved. [27:24]
- ☐ Paul said that he believed what God had said, and he told them the ship would go aground on an island. [27:25-26]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [27:13-15] What happened at the beginning of the ship's journey?
   A gentle wind blew, so the sailors thought they had what they needed and began to sail the ship. But soon after they left, a wind of hurricane force called a northeaster struck the ship, and they were driven on by the wind.

2. [27:16] What did the sailors do to the lifeboat?
   They secured it with difficulty.

3. [27:17] What did the sailors do to the hull of the ship?
   They bound the hull of the ship with ropes or cables. (That is, they passed cables under the ship to hold it together.)

4. [27:17] What did the sailors do to keep the ship from getting stuck on the sandbars of Syrtis?
   They lowered the sea anchor.

5. [27:18-19] What did the crew do as the ship was battered by the wind?
   The sailors threw cargo and the ship's equipment overboard.

Acts 27:13-26 continued

6. [27:20] When the sun and stars did not shine on them for many days, why do you think this caused the men to give up hope of being saved?
   (Answer may vary.) Sailors used the sun and stars to navigate. Perhaps since they could not see the sun and stars, they did not know where they were or where they were going. Perhaps they thought that if clouds still blocked the sun and stars after many days, the storm would continue on.

7. [27:21] What did the men not do for a long time?
   They did not eat.

8. [27:21] When Paul spoke to the sailors, what did he say that they should have done?
   He said that they should have listened to him when he said not to set sail from Crete.

9. [27:22] Why did Paul say that they should take courage?
   None of them would lose their lives. They would only lose the ship.

10. [27:23] Who had stood beside Paul and spoken to him about this?
    An angel of God.

11. [27:24] What did the angel of God say that Paul would do?
    The angel said that Paul would stand before Caesar.

12. [27:24] What do you think it meant that God would give to Paul all those who were sailing with him?
    This probably meant that God would allow all those who were sailing with Paul to live.

13. [27:25] What did Paul say then to encourage the men?
    Paul had faith in God that everything would happen as Paul had been told that it would.

14. [27:26] What else did Paul say would happen?
    The ship would run aground on some island.

Comment Section:

28:11-16

Background: The ship ran aground by an island and the men all got safely to the island. The island was called Malta, and the people of the island were kind to the men who had come from the ship.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Three months later, Paul and the others went on another ship. [28:11]
- ☐ They stopped at a few cities on the way. [28:12-15]
- ☐ When they landed at Puteoli, Paul and his companions stayed with some believers for a week. [28:14]
- ☐ When Paul and his companions were on their way to Rome, some believers from Rome came to them. [28:15]
- ☐ In Rome, Paul was permitted to live by himself with a soldier guarding him. [28:16]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [28:11] How did Paul and the others leave the island of Malta?
   They boarded a ship that had stayed in Malta for the winter.

2. [28:12-13] What cities did they land in?
   They landed at Syracuse, Rhegium, and Puteoli.

3. [28:13-14] What happened in Puteoli?
   Some Christian brothers invited Paul and his companions to stay with them for seven days.

4. [28:15] Where did some Christian brothers from Rome travel so that they could meet Paul and his companions?
   Some of the brothers came to the Market of Appius and to the Three Taverns to meet them.

5. [28:15] What did Paul do when he saw those Christian brothers?
   Paul thanked God and took courage.

6. [28:16] What happened when Paul arrived in Rome?
   Paul was allowed to stay by himself with the soldier who guarded him.

Comment Section: